Link analysis worksheets

A line on a chart is a relationship you can source. No line, no relationship. The chart does not rank who matters and it does not show intent.

Entity register

One row per entity. Use the same short name on every later sheet. Type is person, organisation, place, asset, or event.

ID	Short name	Type	Identifier you actually hold	Source	Note

Relationship log

Direction matters. "A paid B" is not "B paid A". If you do not know the direction, write "linked, direction unknown" and do not draw an arrow.

From	To	Relationship	Dates	Source	What would remove this line

Association matrix

Put entity IDs along the top and the side. A blank cell is a gap, not a zero. Do not colour a cell because the names appeared in the same paragraph.

ID	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								

Before you show the chart

- Every line on the drawing has a row in the relationship log.
- Entities with one mention and no identifier stay off the chart, or sit in a "unresolved names" list.
- You can say, in one sentence, what the chart is for. "Show who shares an address in this file" is a purpose. "Map the network" is not.
- The written assessment still carries the judgement. The chart is the appendix.